



Common roles on a data team

Have you ever played on a sports team or experienced a live sporting event?

For example, take the sport of basketball.

In basketball, there are two teams, each with five players.

The players on each team work together, trying to score points by throwing a ball through a net.

They're all basketball players, but each has an individual position and distinct role to play.

The same is true for a data team.

Everyone's on the team and each one plays a distinct role when completing a project.

In this video, you'll discover the interesting jobs of people who work with data.

Based on what you learn, you may even decide to pursue one of these new career paths instead of cloud data analytics.

That's great!

Whatever direction you end up taking, knowing all about these different jobs will be invaluable.

First up, **data analysts**.

These are truly dynamic people with a wide skill set.

They know how to seamlessly switch between roles on a data team, acting as a **data detective**, a translator, even an artist.

Data analysts **blend the science of analytics with the art of storytelling**.

They work directly with the data.

Data analysts perform data analysis workflows, including importing, manipulating, calculating, and reporting on business data.

When **reporting**, they **visualize and communicate results to stakeholders**, which includes creating **presentations and dashboards for sharing data**.

Data analysts also perform **statistical analyses**.

In working through a data cycle, some of the tasks they may complete include analyzing and reviewing databases, using scripting languages

like Python or SQL to query data, creating visualizations in dashboards in programs, maybe Tableau or Looker, and presenting findings to stakeholders.

Data analysts also play a role in the management and sharing of data, under the direction of a data architect or engineer.

They work with data engineers to clean data and ensure that it's focused on answering the business questions generated during the planning stages.

If all of this sounds exciting to you, then put on your detective's hat, start translating information, and choose your artist's paint palette.

This just might be the career path for you!

Ok, let's meet the data engineer next.

A data engineer is a professional who transforms data into a useful format for analysis and gives it a reliable infrastructure.

They design, create, manage, migrate, and troubleshoot databases used by applications to store and retrieve data.

Much of their work involves developing the structure the team uses to collect, store, and analyze data.

The data engineer is also the one who builds the data pipelines.

Pipelines are a series of processes that transport data from different sources to a destination for storage and analysis.

Engineers also test and maintain pipelines once they have been built.

Data engineers are also tasked with the important job of ensuring that data is accessible to all other members of the team, as permitted by their company's access policies.

Like all members of a data team, engineers must be effective communicators.

They collaborate with team members and other stakeholders to ensure company objectives are met.

It's an exciting career path that makes a powerful impact on everyone in the organization!

Next, we'll get to know data scientists.

These data professionals analyze data, do statistical analysis, and usually build and train machine learning models.

The data scientist is someone who works primarily in data research, identifying business questions, collecting data from multiple sources, organizing it, and finding answers.

Now, let's consider how a data scientist and a data engineer are alike, and how they differ.

Like a data engineer, a data scientist uses coding and scripting skills to clean and summarize data.

They differ in that an engineer typically builds a data pipeline from start to finish, and a data scientist uses the data from the pipeline to draw conclusions.

Data scientists create data analysis workflows.

Along with data analysts and engineers, data scientists import data from various sources, clean it, and use data to perform calculations.

They also understand the business applications of data, and focus on statistics, machine learning, and modeling.

The role of data scientist is another wonderful option for your own data career.

All right, last but definitely not least, we have data architects.

These professionals collaborate with data analysts, data scientists, and data engineers to design the infrastructure of the database.

The data architect helps their team to plan the overall data lifecycle of a solution.

The data architect will usually produce a data or solution architecture diagram to support the management of a data lifecycle in collaboration with the analyst and scientist.

Then, they relay it to the data engineer to build the database!

Every business is different, but those are some of the most common data team roles.

However you make your way into the field, keeping your career options open will allow you to grow and make your own valuable contributions!